



March 2008

Thanks For Listening

Though I am new to the *Digit* world, I must tell you that it's been a fantastic beginning. I love the concept of giving out software along with each issue of your magazine. I have virtually become a tech geek amongst my friends, all thanks to *Digit*. And I like the fact that you actually give your readers' opinions the highest priority. It's wonderful.

However, there is one thing that I would like you to add sooner. I don't know whether it has already been published or not, but I want to know about the audio/video formats, and what players are required to play them, and what goes into creating a format? I once again congratulate Team Digit for the wonderful progress. Great Going!

Ankush Gupta
New Delhi

Thank you for your appreciation, and believe us, it means a lot when readers like yourself notice and write in to us. Yes we do give our readers' opinions the highest priority, and honestly, it would be quite idiotic if we didn't! After all, it's you our readers who have made this magazine what it is, and will help us consistently improve and innovate, so that we can scale new heights.

As for your query about audio and video formats, we have done a Know More About as well as Fast Tracks to Digital Audio, and Digital Video. You will find the PDF copies of such articles and Fast Track books in our December 2007 DVDs.

As for what goes into creating a format, it's not something we can explain here, or perhaps even in an entire Fast Track! It takes years of research, coding and tonnes of money to come up with codecs, containers, colour systems, and more to build a new audio/video format.

Team Digit

Fast Track In Demand

I recently discovered *Digit*, and I soon realised that the Fast Track was very handy and helpful for a computer novice like me. I was wondering whether copies of some of the old issues of Fast Track (e.g., PowerPoint, Web Design, Photoshop, Digital Photography, Virus Proof Your PC, etc.) are still available (in print, or as PDFs). If they are still available, please let me know how I can get my hands on them.

Hemanta Sarkar
Ranchi

Almost every special issue of *Digit* carries the PDF versions of previous magazines. In fact, in our December 2007 issue, we included PDFs of every single *Digit* issue and Fast track that was made before December 2007. Unfortunately, we cannot make you a CD, because if we did, we'd probably be inundated with thousands of requests to do the same for other readers. We promise to include all the previous issues in PDF format in upcoming special issues, and perhaps we can work out something to satiate the thousands of requests we get for a "Fast Track Compendium". For now, please wait for the June 2008 issue, and keep your fingers crossed.

Team Digit

I Love You Digit

This is my first letter to you, and I must say I am proud to be a reader of your beautiful magazine! I love *Digit* more than the Kohinoor diamond, and the words printed in it are like pearls spread over velvet. Your review sections and the comparisons areas are the best among all the other magazines. I love the *Take A Crack* and the other competitions, amongst other things. Still, since you seem to value suggestions from us, I would like to make a few:

1. Improve the packaging, it's way too big and bulky for stands and horrible for subscribers
2. Increase the number of articles that teach us the basics of technology

I also want to make my brother tech-savvy, how do I do that? Anyway, thanks for everything, and keep up the good work.

Rohit Shivnani

We'll try and change the packaging, but it's not as simple as we all would wish. Still, we are always working to improve and innovate with the look, feel and content of *Digit*, and you should be pleasantly surprised soon enough.

We also get a lot of requests to increase the number of articles and pages, and reduce the number of ads, etc. We will try our best to give you as much as possible, but with paper and printing costs skyrocketing, and inflation to boot, it's always increasingly difficult for all magazines to print an added number of pages, without passing on the costs to the readers. Still, you can rest assured that we will always give our all to ensure that you get the most from *Digit* for your hard earned money.

As for your brother, why not ask him to read *Digit*, and also register for our forum at www.thinkdigit.com/forum, where he might find a lot of similar-minded people, and make a few friends, whilst making him tech-savvy.

Team Digit

Aladdin's Lamp

I am a fan of this superb magazine since July 2006, and this is the first time I'm writing to you. One of my good friends told me about this magazine, and I was really blown away by it. After reading the March edition, I couldn't resist writing to congratulate you guys. *Digit* has become my one-stop for all Tech-queries. It is like Aladdin's Lamp for me—make a wish and it will be fulfilled. The two things I love most about *Digit* is that it covers all aspects of technology, all the people who work directly or indirectly with technology, and there's always something that everyone will find useful. How do you do it?

However, I still have just one complaint: You keep everyone but software developers happy. The CD and DVD contain a lot of useful things for developers, but you need to show us how to use those wonderful software. I know it is hard for you to try and please everyone, but we developers would settle for a small section every month dedicated to us. If you feel that the section will not be popular in the magazine, why not provide it to us on the DVD in the PDF format. That way you can keep us happy and also not waste space in the magazine. I hope you will consider my request. Keep up the good job.

Anurag Srivastava

You ask us how we manage to give our readers what they want before they ask for it? We would like to know how our readers always seem to ask for things we're already working on? Look for more developer-friendly content on the DVD in the upcoming issues!

Team Digit

Write to the Editor

E-mail: editor@thinkdigit.com
Snail Mail: The Editor, Digit, KPT House, Plot 41/13, Sector 30, Vashi, Navi Mumbai 400 703

Digit will publish the best letters on these pages. Letters may be edited for clarity. **Please include your complete address in all communication.**
For subscription queries send an e-mail to help@thinkdigit.com

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Age No Bar

You have been my technology navigator for the past 2 years. I am a student, 13 years old, and some tell me, too young to be reading *Digit*. Still, I enjoy reading your magazine, and I go through all the content on your CD and DVD as well. The *Fast Track* series is my favourite, and is fantastic. Keep up the good work. I also have a few suggestions to make.

1. You could make *Fast Track* a standalone book with colour pictures and better paper. You could also include more content. This would be good for students like me who like the Fast Track a lot. That way we could have the option of buying only the Fast Track if we had less money in a particular month.
2. You need to improve your customer care. Some of my December 2007 DVDs were damaged. I sent a mail to help@thinkdigit.com, and still have not received a response.
3. Please increase the amount of freeware on the discs.
4. Although I realise the importance of Ads, I still feel there are more Ads than necessary.
5. You need more/better copy editors, because over the past 1 year, the amount of errors and spelling mistakes has increased.

Still, don't get me wrong. Whatever happens, your mag is THE best. All the other magazines I have read pale in comparison. Due to *Digit* I have become tech-savvy, and have even managed to make my parents tech savvy by making them read it. For that, I thank you *Digit*.

Shishir Upadhy

Some interesting suggestions indeed Shishir. *Digit* readers have always been varied, and as far as we know, the youngest *Digit* reader who wrote to us was just 8 years old; the eldest who has contacted us is 84 years old. So tell the people who think you're too young that technology has no age or gender boundaries!

We get so many suggestions for the Fast Track, that honestly, we have way too many options at the moment. Rest assured that we will evaluate them all and have some interesting new offers for you soon enough. As for the other complaints / suggestions, the Help Desk promises to look into your case immediately and the copy editors promise to try their best not to disappoint you again.

Team Digit

Suggested Reading

I am a BCA second year student. I started to read *Digit* when my first year C language teacher suggested that we do so in order to keep ourselves updated about IT, and to get a wider view of the technology industry. I must admit that I am not a regular reader, but I do buy it when I feel I am losing touch with technology, or when I feel the need to learn about emerging technologies.

I want to suggest that you provide more full-version software in your magazine. Your competitor Chip does this, and although I think the software on your discs are better and more varied, that is the only place that they are beating you. Still, I attach more importance to the magazine, and in this regard, you are miles ahead. So I urge you to provide at least 4 or 5 full version software, across your DVD categories, and fix this tiny chink in your armour.

Honey Chawla

Wow. It's so nice to hear that we're being recommended by teachers, who we have a great deal of respect for. Please thank your teacher on our behalf, for recommending us to the entire class!

Thanks for not mincing your words, we appreciate your suggestion, and we'll try and give you no reason for complaint from here-on. We do however give preference to open source and freeware, and you will always find an abundance of such software on our DVD/CD every month.

Team Digit

11 On 10

I love your magazine, and anxiously wait for it in the beginning of every month. I have already recommended it to everyone in my school, and hopefully you will get a few dozen more regular readers. Please provide the Starry Night Backyard in your CD/DVD, and also some articles on MS-Access, JAVA and C++, as it is part of our school curriculum. I love the Fast Track, but it would be a lot better if it were in colour. As for the magazine, 11 on 10!

Rishav Mukherjee

Thanks for playing your part in popularising *Digit* in your school. We will try and make sure all your wishes are fulfilled over the coming months. As for the Fast Track in colour, a lot of people in the polls and surveys we conducted told us to leave it the way it is. Still, that's not

a definitive "No!", and we're doing our market research. You can rest assured that you will see some pleasant changes in *Digit*, ThinkDigit.com, the Fast Track, as well as the DVD/CD in the months to come.

Team Digit

You Rock!

You guys rock the country with your software, and I like the *Fast Track* series a lot. I have a few suggestions:

- 1) Please add more pages in the magazine. I am not bothered about the advertisements as they are your lifeline.
- 2) The pages of the *Fast Track* series can be more colourful and of better quality.
- 3) Please do justice for the caption "*Your Technology Navigator*" by introducing free gadgets for subscription offers, instead of free issues. Personally, I did not subscribe *Digit* for this reason.
- 4) More gaming reviews and news, a look into the new games for the hardcore gamers (like me!) with the required minimum and recommended configurations.

Last but not least, I am supporting your anti-piracy campaign, but the bottom-line is that software developers need to revise prices for India.

Finally, you rock man! Keep up the good work!

A. Vigneshwar
Chennai

Wow, that's a lot of points you make. We have already answered your first two points in other letters, and they seem to be popular suggestions. As for the subscription offers, we will try and add more of them as quickly as possible. Though you should know that the most popular offers involve an increased number of magazines! Seems people would rather have a longer subscription than gadgets.

As for game reviews, you have to remember that *Digit* is, and never will be, focused on just one topic. We try our best to cover all aspects of technology, and so it's only natural that we can provide you with no more than three or four game reviews every month. Still, we understand the need for gamers to satiate their desires, and that's why we have SKOAR!, India's largest selling gaming magazine. You can visit them at www.skoar.com to find out how to subscribe.

Team Digit